



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

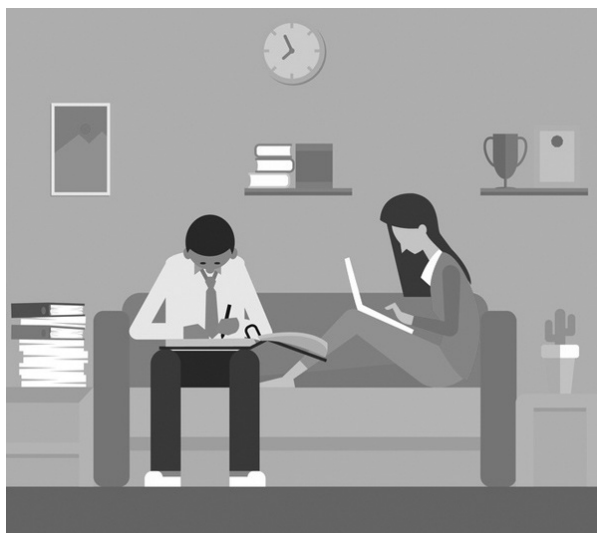
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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: Traveling down the wrong career path!



Learning Outcome

Describe hypothetical situations in written and spoken interactions according to work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Have you ever had a serious discussion about your future with your boss? What happened?
- Describe your ideal working environment.

Can Do Statements

- I can write about jobs, work and money.
- I can write about future action.
- I can talk about what I will be doing or what I will have done.





Let's Explore!

Kirk is overworked and underpaid. He needs to make some changes in his life and reconsider his **career path***.

* A "career path" is the route that someone takes from their start in the job market through to their last position and up to retirement.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- James:** It's been a long week! I'm exhausted.
- Kirk:** Me too. I don't know if I can keep up this pace indefinitely, especially since I am on such a low salary. I feel like they always take advantage of me.
- James:** Have you considered changing jobs? There are a number of advertising agencies downtown.
- Kirk:** Yeah, I think I'm going to consider my options. Soon, I'll be hitting my breaking point. The boss had promised a pay raise and new job title but it hasn't eventuated.
- James:** I can understand your frustration. At your age, you should be starting to not only pay your bills but also be thinking about putting some money away in a savings account each month.
- Kirk:** Maybe I'll ask my boss for a meeting to discuss my future. I'm going to tell her my goals for the future and see whether she will consider making some changes.
- James:** Good idea. Everyone has dreams about what they will be doing in the future. If she is not prepared to have a frank discussion about your future with the agency, then be prepared to move on.
- Kirk:** Exactly. By meeting with my boss before I make any decisions, I will have given her a chance to consider my future at Advantage Ads. Then, I will be looking for possible job opportunities.
- James:** You never know what might happen. She may have some grand plans for you in the agency.
- Kirk:** Maybe ... I am still hoping that I will have achieved my professional goals before I turn thirty.
- James:** You are going to have to tell me what happens.





Let's Practice!

Kirk needs to reconsider many things about his work and his salary.

Instructions: Match the halves 1 - 5 with the ones a - e. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

- | | |
|---|--|
| 1. I don't know if I can keep up this pace, ____ | a. but it hasn't eventuated. |
| 2. The boss had promised a pay raise and a new job title ____ | b. then be prepared to move on. |
| 3. You should be starting ____ | c. to pay your bills each month. |
| 4. You should be thinking about ____ | d. especially since I am on a low salary. |
| 5. If she is not prepared to have a frank discussion, ____ | e. putting some money away in a savings account. |



Let's Practice!

Imagine you feel overwhelmed at work. You are underpaid and are being pulled in a hundred different directions*.

*A "hundred different directions" means that you have too many responsibilities.

- Instructions:*
- Write 120-150 words about a difficult situation at work.
 - You need to speak with your boss.
 - Describe the situation.
 - What have your co-workers said? Use reported speech.
 - What are your career plans? Use Future tenses.
 - Use paragraph structure including a topic sentence, supporting sentences and a concluding sentence.

Proofread your paragraph for grammar, spelling and punctuation errors.





Extension Activity

Watch the movie *Back to the Future*.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Find the movie *Back to the Future*.
- Watch the movie in English with subtitles.
- Take notes about some of the main events.
- Tell a friend about the movie.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I watch a movie about the future.

☐ ☐

I take notes on the main events in the movie.

☐ ☐

I tell a friend about the movie.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **breaking point** (noun): the time when problems become so great that a person can no longer deal with them
e.g. I will be hitting my breaking point soon.
- **pace** (noun): the speed at which something happens
e.g. I don't know if I can keep up this pace indefinitely.
- **grand** (noun): something that is amazing because of its size and significance, etc.
e.g. She may have some grand plans for you in the agency.
- **advertising agency** (noun): an agency employed by companies to create and manage their advertising campaigns
e.g. There are a number of advertising agencies downtown.
- **to eventuate** (verb): to happen as a result of something
e.g. The boss had promised a pay raise and new job title but it hasn't eventuated.





Learning Points

Future Tenses

You can talk about the future in several different ways.

The auxiliary verb **going to** is used to talk about intentions. (An intention is a future plan that you have already considered.)

The auxiliary verb **will** is used to form predictions or simple statements of fact about the future.

The Present Continuous tense is used to make arrangements. (An arrangement is a plan for the future that you have already considered **and talked about with another person.**)

The Present Simple tense is used to talk about future events that are scheduled.

Examples:

- *I'm going to tell him my goals for the future and see whether he will consider making some changes.*
- *Maybe I'll ask my boss for a meeting to discuss my future.*
- *Then, I will be looking for possible job opportunities.*
- *When does the meeting begin?*





Learning Points

Future Continuous and Future Perfect

The Future Continuous tense is used to show an unfinished action or event that will occur at a time in the future.

The Future Perfect tense is used when you talk about a finished action in the future. When you use the tense, you are projecting yourself forward and looking back at the action.

The Future Continuous tense has two different forms:

"*will be doing*" and "*be going to be doing*"

Examples:

Your boss **will be waiting** for you in her office.

Your boss **is going to be waiting** for you in her office.

The Future Perfect tense also has two different forms:

"*will have done*" and "*be going to have done*"

Examples:

You **will have agreed** on a new contract by the time you leave her office.

You **are going to have to** agree on a new contract by the time you leave her office.

Examples:

- *I am still hoping that I will have achieved my professional goals before I turn thirty.*
- *By meeting with my boss before I make any decisions, I will have given her a chance to consider my future at Advantage Ads.*
- *Soon, I will be hitting my breaking point.*
- *Everyone has dreams about what they will be doing in the future.*
- *You are going to have to tell me what happens.*

